

- Claim pricing is based on the contractual discounts plus a professional fee and any applicable sales tax. Pharmacies must submit all ingredients in a compound prescription for online and paper claim submissions. At least one of the ingredients must require a physician's prescription in order to be covered by the Plan. You are responsible for the appropriate brand or generic copay/coinsurance based on ingredients. **Preauthorization may be required.** If the compound includes an experimental or investigational drug, the compound will not be covered. Compound medications are limited to a 30-day supply.
- Ask the pharmacist to submit your claim electronically or online. If the participating retail pharmacy is unable to submit the compound medication claim electronically to CVS Caremark, you will pay the full cost of the medication and must submit the claim for reimbursement. Make sure the pharmacy provides a list of the National Drug Codes (NDCs), quantity and cost for every ingredient in the compound medication and include this information on your claim.
- Claim calculations, copayments, and reimbursement for direct claims are performed using an industry standard reimbursement method for compounds.
- **We divide prescription drugs into categories or tiers:** generic, preferred, and non-preferred medications. Please note specialty medications can be considered either preferred or non-preferred. When an approved generic equivalent is available, that is the drug you will receive, unless you or your physician specifies the prescription must be dispensed as written. When an approved generic equivalent is not available, you will pay the brand name drug's applicable plan copayment/coinsurance. If an approved generic equivalent is available, but you or your physician specifies that the prescription must be dispensed as written with the brand name medication, you will pay the generic copayment plus the difference between the cost of the generic drug and the brand name drug dispensed. Your physician may request the brand name drug be reviewed and if approved as medically necessary, you will pay the applicable brand name copayment/coinsurance.
 - **Generic drugs** are FDA approved prescription medications. They are chemically and therapeutically equivalent to the corresponding brand name drug but are available at a lower price. The FDA requires that generic equivalent medications contain the same active ingredients and be equivalent in strength and dosage to brand name drugs.
 - **Preferred drugs** are FDA approved prescription medications included on the Preferred Drug List developed by CVS Caremark. This list is developed by an independent panel of doctors and pharmacists who ensure the medications are clinically appropriate and cost-effective.
 - **Non-Preferred drugs** are FDA approved prescription medications that may or may not be covered by G.E.H.A, however they are not included on the CVS Caremark Preferred Drug List. Most commonly utilized medications have generic or preferred medications available.

CVS Caremark Formulary

Your prescription drug program includes use of the CVS Caremark Formulary which is developed by an independent panel of doctors and pharmacists who ensure the medications are clinically appropriate and cost-effective. Formularies are reviewed quarterly; medications may change formulary status. You will receive notification if your cost share increases due to a formulary change. In an effort to continue to help promote affordable and clinically appropriate products, there are a select number of drugs that are excluded from the formulary and are not covered by the Plan. For these drugs, generics and/or therapeutic alternative medications in the same drug class are readily available. If one of these excluded drugs is medically necessary, a **preauthorization for medical necessity is required**. We do not cover excluded drugs unless we determine the medical necessity to treat a medical condition based on objective clinical data. New drugs and supplies may be added to the list as they are introduced and may require a review for medical necessity until the formulary status is determined. Please visit our website at geha.com/Prescriptions-Summary to view formulary medications and the most current list of specialty drugs. You may also call CVS Specialty at 800-237-2767.

The Elevate Plus Option includes the Advanced Control Specialty Formulary (ACSF). The ACSF may reduce your out-of-pocket costs yet may limit your options due to a strict formulary. The ACSF focuses on specialty medications that are similar to one another, with similar effectiveness and safety. The Elevate Option includes a Value Formulary. The Value Formulary is a closely managed drug list and an array of utilization management (UM) strategies, including classes largely managed with specialty medications. Both Elevate and Elevate Plus formularies incorporate step therapy, where a generic/preferred medication is used prior to a brand and/or non-preferred medication.

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